

A There is no functional difference between Primary Master, Primary Slave, Secondary Master and Secondary Slave. These designations only differentiate between the different devices. Your primary hard disk—the one with your OS—can be the secondary slave, if you so wish.

An IDE device, when connected to the Primary IDE port (via an IDE cable connected to the port), becomes a Primary IDE device. An IDE hard drive or optical drive can be set to Master or Slave by changing the connection of the jumper—a small plastic plug with metal sleeves that forms a circuit between a pair of pins.

The jumper settings of a drive can be accessed just beside the IDE data cable connector. The hard disk or optical drive will have the jumper settings mentioned on the label—what setting will set the drive to master, slave, and more. Jumpers are tiny, and you might need a pair of tweezers to handle them.

A BI-OS Conflict

Q I have an NForce4 motherboard with 512 MB of DDR RAM. I want to install Windows XP on it, but I get error 0x0000007B during installation. The hard drive is detected by the BIOS but not by the Windows XP installer CD. I have tried replacing the 250 GB SATA hard drive with my old 120 GB SATA drive and even replaced the RAM, but the problem persists.

Manish Paswan

A The 0x00007B error is normally the “inaccessible_boot_device” error where windows can’t find the partition that has your OS. The most common reason for this is that you may have configured your SATA hard drive in the RAID configuration in the BIOS. You may need to check for this in the BIOS and set the hard drive back to legacy IDE mode. But if you intend to use it in RAID configuration, you can still install Windows XP. You need to keep the RAID driver floppy disk ready before starting the installation. If you don’t have it, you can create one using the driver CD that came with the motherboard.

After the Windows XP bootable CD boots and the installation begins, press [F6]. You will be prompted to insert the driver disk; use the RAID driver disk you created. Select the correct driver from the list and continue. XP shouldn’t have any problems installing.

Got Java?

Q I have a Compaq Presario 4010 running Window 98, with 128 MB of RAM and a Celeron at 367 MHz. While trying to run the “Quick Restore/Custom Restore” CD, I get a message: “Applet sqcd not initied.” Pressing the restore button gives an “Error on page” message.

B Mazumdar

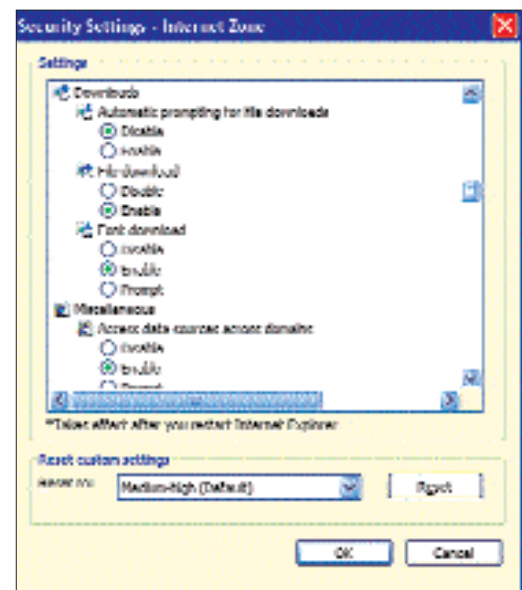
A The “Applet notinitied” error occurs when the Java Virtual Machine is either not installed or is corrupt/damaged. You will need to download and install the JRE from the Sun Java Web site at <http://java.com/getjava/index.jsp> or by visiting <http://java-virtual-machine.net/download.html>.

Blame It On IE

Q I have Windows XP SP2. I am not able to download any files. When I try to download a file, I get an error (*as shown below*). I am using Norton Internet Security 2005; I contacted Symantec Corp. and they just said something to the effect that it wasn’t their fault. What do I do?

Harris

A Your Internet Security settings are set to prevent file downloads. This probably happened accidentally. You can change this setting: open Control Panel > Internet Settings. Go to the Security tab and click “Custom Level”. In the Settings list, look for “Downloads”, and under this, you will see “File Download”. Click on the radio button next to Enable and click on OK twice. The new settings will take effect immediately, and you’ll be able to download.



Set the download settings in the IE Security Settings tab

Pausable?

Q I saw an ad for a Pentium 4 system with Window XP Media Center Edition, which said you could pause Live TV. I want to know whether this is possible, and how?

Rajesh Kumar

A Windows XP Media Center Edition, as well as many of the PVR (Personal Video Recorder) software available, have a feature called timeshift. Using the timeshift feature, it is possible to pause, rewind or even skip parts of a live telecast. In the timeshift mode of operation, the PC records the telecast at the same time as it displays it on the Desktop. When the Pause button on the Media Center remote is pressed, the recording continues, but the display on the Desktop is frozen until the Pause button is pressed again. Playback resumes from the point that it was paused, which can happen because the telecast that was recorded during the pause interval is maintained as a buffer. Rest assured—the advertisement is not misleading!